Significant judgment is required in evaluating the Company's uncertain tax positions and determining its provision for income taxes. Although the Company believes that it has appropriately reserved for its uncertain tax positions, no assurance can be given that the final tax outcome of these matters will not be different than expectations. The Company will adjust these reserves in light of changing facts and circumstances, such as the closing of a tax audit, the refinement of an estimate, the closing of a statutory audit period or changes in applicable tax law. To the extent that the final tax outcome of these matters is different than the amounts recorded, such differences would impact the provision for income taxes in the period in which such determination is made. The provision for income taxes includes the impact of reserve provisions and changes to the reserves that are considered appropriate, as well as related net interest.

The Company recognizes liabilities for anticipated tax audit issues in the U.S. and other domestic and international tax jurisdictions based on its estimate of whether, and the extent to which, the tax positions are more likely than not to be sustained based on the technical merits. The Company believes that it has appropriate support for the income tax positions taken and to be taken on its tax returns and that its accruals for tax liabilities are adequate for all open years based on an assessment of many factors including past experience and interpretations of tax laws applied to the facts of each matter.

The Company believes it maintains appropriate reserves to offset any potential income tax liabilities that may arise upon final resolution of matters for open tax years. If such reserve amounts ultimately prove to be unnecessary, the resulting reversal of such reserves could result in tax benefits being recorded in the period the reserves are no longer deemed necessary. If such amounts prove to be less than an ultimate assessment, a future charge to expense would be recorded in the period in which the assessment is determined.

The following table summarizes the activity related to the Company's gross unrecognized tax benefits from April 1, 2016 to March 31, 2019 (amounts in millions):

	Year Ended March 31,		
	2019	2018	2017
Beginning balance	$ 436.0	$ 398.5	$ 220.7
Increases related to acquisitions	329.7	—	193.3
Decreases related to settlements with tax authorities	(8.3)	(0.1)	(11.7)
Decreases related to statute of limitation expirations	(16.2)	(10.9)	(7.6)
Increases related to current year tax positions	27.8	30.3	26.3
Increases (decreases) related to prior year tax positions	(5.6)	18.2	(22.5)
Ending balance	$ 763.4	$ 436.0	$ 398.5

As of March 31, 2019 and March 31, 2018, the Company had accrued interest and penalties related to tax contingencies of $88.1 million and $80.8 million, respectively. Interest and penalties charged to operations for the years ended March 31, 2018 and 2017 related to the Company's uncertain tax positions were $5.4 million and $5.8 million, respectively. Previously accrued interest and penalties that were released during the year ended March 31, 2019 were $37.5 million.

The total amount of gross unrecognized tax benefits was $763.4 million and $436.0 million as of March 31, 2019 and March 31, 2018, respectively, of which $664.4 million and $436.0 million is estimated to impact the Company's effective tax rate, if recognized. The Company estimates that it is reasonably possible unrecognized tax benefits as of March 31, 2019 could decrease by approximately $50.0 million in the next 12 months. Positions that may be resolved include various U.S. and non-U.S. matters.